

Jarlsburg tempeh casserole

The most comforting of comfort foods: the tuna casserole. But hold on. This is a tempeh casserole, made with crisp tempeh and Jarlsburg cheese and topped with cornflakes. I recommend using a high-quality natural foods cornflake or combination grain cornflake for the topping.

Vegetable cooking spray

1 package (8 ounces) tempeh [250g]

¼ cup canola or high-oleic safflower oil
[60ml]

Salt

1 small onion, chopped

1 small red bell pepper, finely diced

3 tablespoons unbleached all-purpose flour
[25ml]

2 cups plain soy milk [500ml]

1 tablespoon vegetarian Worcestershire
sauce

1 cup grated Jarlsburg cheese [80g]

2 cups cooked egg noodles [280g]

1 cup frozen peas [120g]

Freshly ground pepper

½ cup crushed cornflakes or dry unseasoned
bread crumbs [35g]

1. **Preheat** the oven to 375°F [190°C]. Coat a 2- to 3-quart [2- to 3-L] casserole dish with cooking spray. Split the tempeh cake horizontally so it is half as thick; then cut it crosswise in half to make 4 squares.
2. In a large deep skillet or flameproof casserole, **heat** the oil over medium-high heat until very hot. Add the tempeh squares and fry, turning once, until lightly browned on both sides, 2 to 3 minutes. Drain on paper towels and sprinkle with salt. As soon as the tempeh is cool enough to handle, cut it into ½-inch [1-cm] cubes.
3. Add the onion to the oil remaining in the pan and cook over medium heat, **stirring** several times, until lightly browned, 5 to 7 minutes. Add the bell pepper and cook until softened, about 3 minutes longer.
4. Add the flour and cook, stirring constantly, for 1 minute. **Whisk** in the soy milk and bring to a boil, stirring frequently until the sauce thickens. Reduce the heat and simmer about 3 minutes. Stir in the Worcestershire sauce.

5. **Remove** from the heat and stir in the Jarlsburg cheese until melted and smooth, then add the noodles and peas. Season with salt and pepper to taste. Transfer to the prepared baking dish.
6. Sprinkle the cornflakes or bread crumbs over all and **bake** for 25 to 30 minutes, until lightly browned and crisp on top.

SERVES 4 TO 6

